Answers and talk notes

Find and Compare with Percentages

What your student is learning

Tonight we compare two records fairly — two quiz scores out of different totals — by turning each into a percent.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **D.** 15. 50% is half, so half of 30 is 15.
2. **B.** 30. 25% of 40 is 10, so 75% is 3 × 10 = 30.
3. **A.** 84/100. Multiply both numbers by 4: 21 × 4 = 84 and 25 × 4 = 100, so 84/100.
4. **C.** 90%. Multiply both numbers by 10: 9 out of 10 is 90 out of 100, so 90%.
5. **D.** The scores are equal: both are 80%. The scores are equal: both are 80%, because 16/20 = 80/100 and 4/5 = 80/100.

Talk about it

Why can't we compare the two scores just by looking at the top numbers?

Home mission

Make up two quiz scores with different totals, like 7 out of 10 and 12 out of 20. Can your student scale both to 100 and say which is better?

When they are stuck, ask

- A percent of WHAT? What is the whole for each one?
- Can we write both of these out of 100?
- Now that the wholes match, which is greater?

Try not to say

- The bigger number of correct answers is the better score.
- A bigger percent always means a bigger amount.
- You can compare percents without knowing the totals.